NAME: _____ CLASS: _____ TEACHER: _____

KEY TOPIC 1 CHRONOLOGICAL ENQUIRY SEQUENCE • 1954–1960

Key Topic 1: The Development of the Civil Rights Movement, 1954–60

Segregation, Legal Challenges, School Desegregation & The Montgomery Bus Boycott



HISTORICAL PRIMARY RECORD • SEPTEMBER 1957

Soldiers of the 101st Airborne Escorting the Little Rock Nine, September 1957

Federal paratroopers of the 101st Airborne Division escort nine Black teenagers into Central High School, Little Rock, Arkansas, enforcing federal court desegregation orders against state resistance.

PEARSON EDEXCEL OPTION 33 • KEY TOPIC 1 CONTENT — OFFICIAL SPECIFICATION DIRECTORY

1 The Position of Black Americans in the Early 1950s

- Segregation, discrimination and voting rights in the Southern states.
- The work of civil rights organisations, including the NAACP and CORE.

2 Developments in Education

- Reasons for, key features and significance of the Brown v. Topeka case (1954).
- Reasons for, key features and significance of the events at **Little Rock High School (1957)**.

3 The Montgomery Bus Boycott and Its Impact, 1955–60

- Causes and events of the **Montgomery Bus Boycott**. The significance of **Rosa Parks**.
- Reasons for the success and importance of the boycott. The Supreme Court ruling. The Civil Rights Act (1957).
- The significance of the leadership of **Martin Luther King**. The setting up of the **SCLC**.

4 Opposition to the Civil Rights Movement

- The Ku Klux Klan and violence, including the murder of Emmet Till in 1955.
- Opposition to desegregation in the South, including the 'Dixiecrats' and the setting up of White Citizens' Councils.

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 1: CHRONOLOGICAL ANCHORS (KEY TOPIC 1)

Instructions: As you study each enquiry lesson, complete the timeline missions by sketching and annotating in the corresponding dual-coding sketchpads below.

17 May 1954 • Brown v. Board of Education Ruling

JUDICIAL PRECEDENT

The US Supreme Court unanimously rules (9–0) that state laws establishing separate public schools for Black and white students are unconstitutional, dismantling Plessy v. Ferguson.

28 August 1955 • Lynching of Emmett Till in Mississippi

CATALYST FOR ACTION

14-year-old Emmett Till is brutally murdered by white supremacists in Money, Mississippi. His mother's open-casket funeral in Chicago shocks the nation and galvanizes civil rights resistance.

1 December 1955 • Rosa Parks Arrest in Montgomery

GRASSROOTS TRIGGER

NAACP secretary Rosa Parks refuses to surrender her seat on a segregated Montgomery bus, prompting Jo Ann Robinson and the WPC to organize an immediate, community-wide bus boycott.

"Chronology is critical: Brown v. Board May 1954 before Montgomery Bus Boycott December 1955."

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 2: CHRONOLOGICAL ANCHORS (KEY TOPIC 1)

Instructions: Complete the dual-coding sketches to permanently anchor these chronological turning points in long-term memory.

12 March 1956 • The Southern Manifesto Signed

MASSIVE RESISTANCE

101 Southern congressmen and senators sign the Declaration of Constitutional Principles, pledging to use all lawful means to resist federal school integration and preserve Jim Crow.

24 September 1957 • Eisenhower Sends 101st Airborne to Little Rock

FEDERAL ENFORCEMENT

President Eisenhower federalizes the Arkansas National Guard and deploys 1,000 paratroopers of the 101st Airborne Division to protect nine Black students entering Central High School.

9 September 1957 • Civil Rights Act of 1957 Enacted

FEDERAL STATUTE

The first federal civil rights legislation since Reconstruction establishes the Civil Rights Division in the Department of Justice and the US Commission on Civil Rights.

What was the position of Black Americans in the early 1950s?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 • How did the 1896 Plessy v. Ferguson ruling legally entrench racial segregation across the American South?

- Plessy v. Ferguson (1896)
- 'Separate but equal'
- Legal segregation basis

2 • In what ways did Jim Crow laws enforce daily economic, social, and physical subordination for Black Southern...

- Jim Crow statutes
- Segregated public facilities
- White supremacy codes

3 • Why did discriminatory voting restrictions leave Black Americans virtually powerless to challenge Southern se...

- Poll taxes enforced
- Literacy test hurdles
- Black disenfranchisement (<5%)

4 • How did the NAACP's legal strategy lay the groundwork for dismantling the 'separate but equal' doctrine in fede...

- NAACP legal fund
- Thurgood Marshall counsel
- Courtroom litigation strategy

5 • Why did early non-violent direct action by CORE mark an important tactical shift from courtroom litigation?

- CORE non-violent direct
- Journey of Reconciliation (1947)
- Gandhian protest tactics

"Brown v. Board: Earl Warren's unanimous 9–0 Supreme Court ruling that 'separate is inherently unequal'."

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins] EDEXCEL PAPER 3

Score: [/ 12]

Explain why it was difficult for Black Americans in the Southern states to exercise their civil rights in the early 1950s. [12 marks]

You may use in your answer:	• Jim Crow laws and legal disenfranchisement	• The Ku Klux Klan (KKK) and white supremacist terror	***(You must also use information of your own.)***

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One decisive reason was that... • For example, this meant that... • This directly triggered... • Therefore, this was critical because... • On the other hand, another factor was... • Consequently, the ultimate result was...*

Write your response in the space provided below:

(Response continues on Page 6)

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 1.1). In the drawing box, sketch a segregated bus or municipal waiting room sign alongside the scales of justice to symbolize the Plessy v. Ferguson doctrine. [ ] Done

QUESTION 1 PRACTICE **INFERENCE FROM SOURCE A** **4 MARKS • 5 MINS** **Score: [/ 4]**

Give two things you can infer from Source A about legal segregation in the American South in the early 1950s. [4 marks]

SOURCE A *Mississippi Department of Archives and History, State Statute Compendium*

The Mississippi State Code (§7785): All railroad companies and bus operators carrying passengers in this state shall provide equal but separate accommodations for the white and colored races by providing separate ca...

(i) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

(ii) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

How did developments in education challenge segregation (1954–57)?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 • Why was the 1954 Brown v. Board of Education decision a landmark turning point in the legal struggle against s...

- Brown v. Topeka (1954)
- Chief Justice Warren (9–0)
- Desegregation ordered 'all deliberate speed'

2 • How did Southern political leaders organize 'Massive Resistance' to block court-ordered school integration?

- 1956 Southern Manifesto
- Massive Resistance campaign
- Deep South non-compliance

3 • Why did Governor Orval Faubus deploy the Arkansas National Guard to surround Little Rock Central High Sch...

- Little Rock Central High
- Governor Orval Faubus
- National Guard blockade

4 • How did President Eisenhower's deployment of the 101st Airborne Division demonstrate federal supremacy ove...

- Eisenhower federalises troops
- 101st Airborne Division
- Armed student escorts

5 • What did the closure of Little Rock high schools during the 'Lost Year' reveal about the limits of initial desegreg...

- Little Rock high schools closed
- 'The Lost Year'
- Private white academies

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins] EDEXCEL PAPER 3

Score: [/ 12]

Explain why the Supreme Court decision in Brown v. Board of Education (1954) was a turning point in the struggle for civil rights. [12 marks]

You may use in your answer:	• The legal doctrine of 'separate but equal'	• The role of the NAACP and Thurgood Marshall	*(You must also use information of your own.)*

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One decisive reason was that... • For example, this meant that... • This directly triggered... • Therefore, this was critical because... • On the other hand, another factor was... • Consequently, the ultimate result was...*

Write your response in the space provided below:

(Response continues on Page 9)

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 1.2). In the drawing box, sketch the 101st Airborne paratrooper escorting the Little Rock Nine past hostile crowds into Central High School. [ ] Done

"Montgomery Improvement Association: Domestic workers walked up to 12 miles a day to defeat bus segregation."

QUESTION 1 PRACTICE **INFERENCE FROM SOURCE A** **4 MARKS • 5 MINS** **Score: [/ 4]**

Give two things you can infer from Source A about the opposition faced by Black students attempting to desegregate Southern schools in 1957. [4 marks]

SOURCE A *United States Supreme Court, Brown v. Board of Education of Topeka, 347 U.S. 483 (1954)*

Does segregation of children in public schools solely on the basis of race, even though the physical facilities and other 'tangible' factors may be equal, deprive the children of the minority group of equal educatio...

(i) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

(ii) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

How did the Montgomery Bus Boycott happen, and why did it succeed?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 • Why was Rosa Parks' deliberate refusal to give up her seat the ideal catalyst to spark a citywide bus boycott?

- Rosa Parks arrest
- Montgomery NAACP secretary
- Women's Political Council flyers

2 • How did the formation of the Montgomery Improvement Association (MIA) unite the local Black community be...

- Montgomery Improvement Association
- Martin Luther King Jr.
- Non-violent boycott rally

3 • How did the community-run carpool network enable 50,000 citizens to sustain the boycott for over a year?

- 381-day sustained boycott
- Volunteer carpool network
- Bus company financial losses

4 • Why was the Browder v. Gayle Supreme Court ruling decisive in ending segregated public transit in Montgome...

- Browder v. Gayle (1956)
- Bus segregation unconstitutional
- 14th Amendment violation

5 • What was the broader national significance of the Montgomery Bus Boycott for the emerging civil rights move...

- Desegregated municipal buses
- SCLC foundation (1957)
- National direct-action catalyst

"Little Rock Nine (1957): Eisenhower deployed the 101st Airborne to enforce federal constitutional supremacy."

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins] EDEXCEL PAPER 3

Score: [/ 12]

Explain why the Montgomery Bus Boycott succeeded in achieving its aims between 1955 and 1956. [12 marks]

You may use in your answer:
- The Montgomery Improvement Association (MIA) and Martin Luther King Jr.
- The Supreme Court ruling in Browder v. Gayle (1956)

(You must also use information of your own.)

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One decisive reason was that... • For example, this meant that... • This directly triggered... • Therefore, this was critical because... • On the other hand, another factor was... • Consequently, the ultimate result was...*

Write your response in the space provided below:

(Response continues on Page 12)

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 1.3). In the drawing box, sketch Rosa Parks on the Montgomery city bus alongside domestic workers walking on foot during the 381-day boycott. [ ] Done

QUESTION 1 PRACTICE **INFERENCE FROM SOURCE A** **4 MARKS • 5 MINS** **Score: [/ 4]**

Give two things you can infer from Source A about the determination of the Black community during the Montgomery Bus Boycott (1955–56). [4 marks]

SOURCE A *Montgomery Municipal Court Archives, Alabama Department of Archives and History*
Contemporary archival extract.

(i) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

(ii) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

Why did white people in the South resist integration, and how did they do it?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 • How did White Citizens' Councils use economic intimidation and blacklisting to suppress Southern civil rights ...

- White Citizens' Councils
- Economic boycotts & firings
- Southern business intimidation

2 • Why did the brutal murder of 14-year-old Emmett Till shock international opinion and galvanize civil rights su...

- Emmett Till murder (1955)
- Open-casket funeral photos
- National outrage sparked

3 • What did the swift acquittal of Emmett Till's killers demonstrate about the Southern judicial system?

- Sumner Mississippi trial
- All-white jury acquittal
- Confessed killers protected

4 • How did violent KKK bombing campaigns against churches and homes paradoxically strengthen civil rights re...

- Ku Klux Klan resurgence
- Black church bombings
- Civil rights home attacks

5 • Why did the Civil Rights Act of 1957 fail to significantly expand Black voter registration across the Deep South?

- 1957 Civil Rights Act
- Strom Thurmond filibuster
- Weak voting enforcement

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins] EDEXCEL PAPER 3

Score: [/ 12]

Explain why white segregationists mounted 'Massive Resistance' across the South between 1954 and 1960. [12 marks]

You may use in your answer:
- White Citizens' Councils and economic intimidation
- The 'Southern Manifesto' and state governors

(You must also use information of your own.)

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One decisive reason was that... • For example, this meant that... • This directly triggered... • Therefore, this was critical because... • On the other hand, another factor was... • Consequently, the ultimate result was...*

Write your response in the space provided below:

(Response continues on Page 15)

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 1.4). In the drawing box, sketch the Capitol dome with 101 Southern congressmen signing the Southern Manifesto alongside a White Citizens' Council placard. [ ] Done

QUESTION 1 PRACTICE **INFERENCE FROM SOURCE A** **4 MARKS • 5 MINS** **Score: [/ 4]**

Give two things you can infer from Source A about the racial violence and terror inflicted on Black Americans in the South in 1955. [4 marks]

SOURCE A *Special Collections, Mitchell Memorial Library, Mississippi State University*
Contemporary archival extract.

(i) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

(ii) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

Question 3(a): Source Utility [8 marks • 12 mins]

Study Sources B and C. How useful are Sources B and C for an enquiry into the reasons for the success of the Montgomery Bus Boycott (1955–56)?

Target: AO3 [8 marks]: Analyse sources on Content, Contextual Knowledge, and Provenance (Nature, Origin, Purpose).

SOURCE B — Primary Evidence

"Another woman has been arrested and thrown into jail because she refused to get up out of her seat on the bus for a white person... This has to be stopped. Negroes have rights too. If Negroes did not ride the buses, they could not operate; three-fourths of the riders are Negroes. We are asking every Negro to stay off the buses on Monday in protest of the arrest and trial. Don't ride the buses to work, to town, to school, or anywhere on Monday. If you must work, take a cab, or share a ride, or walk."

Provenance: Protest leaflet written and mimeographed overnight by Jo Ann Robinson and the Women's Political Council (WPC), distributing 35,000 copies.

SOURCE C — Primary Evidence

"We are here this evening for serious business. We are here in a general sense because first and foremost we are American citizens, and we are determined to apply our citizenship to the fullness of its meaning... There comes a time when people get tired of being trampled over by the iron feet of oppression. Our method will be that of persuasion, not coercion. We will say to the people: let your conscience be your guide. Our actions must be guided by the highest Christian principles of love and non-violence."

Provenance: Speech delivered by Dr Martin Luther King Jr. at Holt Street Baptist Church to over 5,000 citizens at the first mass rally of the boycott.

SOURCE B UTILITY (CONTENT & COP): SHOWS THE IMMEDIATE GRASSROOTS MOBILIZATION, THE ROLE OF JO ANN ROBINSON/WPC, AND THE DELIBERATE STRATEGY OF ECONOMIC PRESSURE (75% BLACK PASSENGERS). *(Analyse Content, Historical Context & Provenance NOP)*

Score: [/ 8]

HISTORICAL INTERPRETATIONS 1 & 2

Study Interpretations 1 and 2 below for Questions 3(b), 3(c), and 3(d)

INTERPRETATION 1

"The Montgomery Bus Boycott was fundamentally the achievement of organized Black working-class women. Long before national male leaders arrived, Jo Ann Robinson and the Women's Political Council had methodically planned a bus strike. Within hours of Rosa Parks' arrest, Robinson spent the night mimeographing 35,000 leaflets. Over the next 381 days, thousands of domestic maids and cooks walked up to twelve miles a day in freezing winter and blistering summer, while local drivers ran an intricate 300-car dispatch network. It was this daily grassroots courage and economic sacrifice—depriving the bus company of over 70% of its passengers—that brought Montgomery to its knees."

Historian Danielle L. McGuire, 'At the Dark End of the Street: Black Women, Rape, and Resistance' (2010)

INTERPRETATION 2

"While grassroots logistics sustained the boycott, the movement achieved national momentum and ultimate victory because of the charismatic moral leadership of Dr Martin Luther King Jr. King provided the strategic vision and rhetorical genius that unified disparate local factions and prevented violent retaliation despite firebombings and arrests. He framed the local dispute as a national crusade for Christian justice, attracting essential northern financial support and national media coverage. Crucially, local economic pressure alone could not change municipal segregation laws; success ultimately depended on the legal strategy that secured the Supreme Court's Browder v. Gayle ruling."

Historian David L. Lewis, 'King: A Critical Biography' (1970)

Question 3(b): Main Difference in Views [4 marks • 5 mins]

Score: [/ 4]

Study Interpretations 1 and 2. They give different views about the main reason why the Montgomery Bus Boycott succeeded. What is the main difference between these views? Explain your answer, using details from both interpretations.

Formula: Interpretation 1 argues that the boycott succeeded primarily due to grassroots mobilization and economic sacrifices of working-class Black women (Jo Ann Robinson, WPC, walking domestic workers), whereas Interpretation 2 argues that success was primarily driven by Dr Martin Luther King Jr.'s charismatic moral leadership and federal legal intervention (Browder v. Gayle).

Question 3(c): Reason Why Interpretations Differ [4 marks • 5 mins]

Score: [/ 4]

Suggest one reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 give different views about the main reason why the Montgomery Bus Boycott succeeded. You may use Sources B and C to help explain your answer.

Examiner Guidance: The historians give different views because they have relied on different types of primary evidence. The author of Interpretation 1 has focused on grassroots evidence such as Source B, highlighting the practical organizational labor of the Women's Political Council and economic leverage. In contrast, the author of Interpretation 2 has drawn upon evidence such as Source C, emphasizing Dr King's philosophical oratory and national leadership.

QUESTION 3(D) ESSAY PLANNING & CRITERIA SETUP

16 Marks + 4 SPaG = 20 Marks • 25 Mins

How far do you agree with Interpretation 2 about the reasons for the success of the Montgomery Bus Boycott (1955–56)?

Thesis Prompt: Establish your judgment criteria, select quotes from Interpretations 1 & 2, and deploy contextual historical knowledge.

Criteria Planning Canvas: Establish criteria benchmark, map quotes from Int 1 & Int 2, and outline your verdict: *(Essay continues on Page 19)*

Level 4 Target (13–16 Marks): Balanced analysis of both views • Sustained contextual knowledge • Justified criteria-led judgment. **SPaG: 4/4 MARKS**

Question 3(d): Evaluative Essay on Historical Interpretations

AO4: [/ 16] | SPaG: [/ 4] | Total: [/ 20]

[16 MARKS + 4 SPAG = 20 MARKS • TIMED ESSAY: 25 MINS]

How far do you agree with Interpretation 2 about the reasons for the success of the Montgomery Bus Boycott (1955–56)?

Write your response in the space provided below:

Band 4 Criteria Check:	[ ] Criteria Established	[ ] Both Ints Explored	[ ] Precise Own Knowledge	[ ] Justified Verdict	**Teacher Sign-off:** _____

"Question 3(d): Build a criteria-led sustained judgment; weigh both interpretations with precise own knowledge." **19/20**

STUDENT ASSESSMENT RECORD • KEY TOPIC 1 TRACKER

Paper 3: Conflict at Home and Abroad: the USA, 1954–1975 (The Development of the Civil Rights Movement, 1954–60)

PUPIL: _____ **TARGET GRADE:** ☐ **PREDICTED:** ☐ **ATTITUDE:** 1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5

#	ENQUIRY / ASSESSMENT UNIT	DO NOW (10M)	Q1 INFER (4M)	Q2 EXPLAIN (12M)	MODULE TOTAL
1	**KT1.1: What was the position of Black Americans in the early 1950s?** *"What was the position of Black Americans in the early 1950s?"*	/ 10	/ 4	/ 12	/ 26
2	**KT1.2: How did developments in education challenge segregation (1954–57)?** *"How did developments in education challenge segregation (1954–57)?"*	/ 10	/ 4	/ 12	/ 26
3	**KT1.3: How did the Montgomery Bus Boycott happen, and why did it succeed?** *"How did the Montgomery Bus Boycott happen, and why did it succeed?"*	/ 10	/ 4	/ 12	/ 26
4	**KT1.4: Why did white people in the South resist integration, and how did they do it?** *"Why did white people in the South resist integration, and how did they do it?"*	/ 10	/ 4	/ 12	/ 26
★	**Section B Capstone Assessment (pp. 16–19)** *Q3(a) Utility [8m] • Q3(b) Study Views [4m] • Q3(c) Why Differ [4m] • Q3(d) Evaluative Essay [20m]*	Q3(a): / 8	Q3(b): / 4	Q3(c): / 4 • Q3(d): / 20	/ 36
KEY TOPIC 1 CUMULATIVE ASSESSMENT TOTALS		**Do Now: / 40**	**Q1 Infer: / 16**	**Q2 Cause: / 48**	**/ 140**

TEACHER FORMATIVE ASSESSMENT • WWW / EBI FEEDBACK

WHAT WENT WELL (WWW):

_____

_____

_____

EVEN BETTER IF (EBI):

_____

_____

_____

Teacher Signature: _____ **Date:** _____

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KT 1.1	KT 1.2	KT 1.3	KT 1.4
SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ
Score: / 20	**Score: / 20**	**Score: / 20**	**Score: / 20**